

Poetry Study





About the Course

Students study poetic devices and forms and practice writing poetry themselves.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Poetry: Grade 7



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7	Poetry Study: Grade 7 1 time/week 20 min	What Is Poetry?

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Poetry: Grade 7				
Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Study: Grade 7



Planning & Prep

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LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Poetry Study: Grade 7

☐ Some of the poems are given as links or PDFs. You may want to print those out.

☐ Make sure the student has a Commonplace Book to write down any poems they especially enjoy. You will want to remind them to do that during poetry time, or set another time in the afternoon to do that.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Poetry Study: Grade 7



What Is Poetry?



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Poetry Study: Grade 7

How To Teach



Introduce

Tell something about the poet or the kind of poem or fable to prepare students. Remember that poems are like paintings—they not only convey ideas, they create an experience with the sound of words, the way the words are arranged, and the emotions, thoughts, and images they evoke.



Read

Read the poem aloud in order to hear the sounds and meter. Have students read it aloud as well as it is helpful to hear poetry read by different voices. Try to read paying attention to the punctuation as well as the line breaks to get the sense of the poem.



Discuss

Allow students to share any thoughts or connections. What are your impressions of the poem? Talk about anything that stood out to you: the images, ideas, words, phrases, sounds, or even physical look of the poem. What kinds of things is the poem about?



Reread

Read (or have the student read) the poem again.



Connect

Students may choose to add poems to their Commonplace Book or mark them to copy later.

Poetry Study: Grade 7

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 1

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ INTRO

What makes something a poem? Let's explore this question in our book by British poet, Poet Laureate (2007-2009), and author Michael Rosen.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Suggest Things Ch.1 p.1-6

- Rosen writes, "They don't try to give us answers. They leave us to do a lot of the figuring out." Read the poem below and ask questions about it and what it might be saying. You don't have to know the answers.

"The Listeners"

By Walter De La Mare

'Is there anybody there?' said the Traveller,
Knocking on the moonlit door;
And his horse in the silence champed the grasses
Of the forest's ferny floor:
And a bird flew up out of the turret,
Above the Traveller's head:
And he smote upon the door again a second time;
'Is there anybody there?' he said.
But no one descended to the Traveller;
No head from the leaf-fringed sill
Leaned over and looked into his grey eyes,
Where he stood perplexed and still.
But only a host of phantom listeners
That dwelt in the lone house then
Stood listening in the quiet of the moonlight
To that voice from the world of men:
Stood thronging the faint moonbeams on the dark stair,
That goes down to the empty hall,
Harkening in an air stirred and shaken
By the lonely Traveller's call.
And he felt in his heart their strangeness,
Their stillness answering his cry,
While his horse moved, cropping the dark turf,
'Neath the starred and leafy sky;
For he suddenly smote on the door, even
Louder, and lifted his head:—
'Tell them I came, and no one answered,
That I kept my word,' he said.
Never the least stir made the listeners,
Though every word he spake
Fell echoing through the shadowiness of the still house
From the one man left awake:
Ay, they heard his foot upon the stirrup,
And the sound of iron on stone,
And how the silence surged softly backward,
When the plunging hoofs were gone.

WEEK 2 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 2

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What does it mean that a poem suggests things?

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Give an Impression, Poetry Can Play With Words Ch.1 p.7-19

- How does the author, Eugene Field, play with words in the poem "Wynken, Blynken, and Nod"?
- ∞ Link: "Wynken, Blynken, and Nod"

WEEK 3 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 3

📄 Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What does it mean that a poem gives an impression?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Be Symbolic, Poetry Can Be Personal Ch.1 p.20-27

- Rosen said that "Tennyson has turned the eagle into a person and then into a symbol of power" (p.23). Giving animals or things feelings, ideas, and thoughts so they can behave in ways people behave is called personification. Read the poem "The Oven Bird" by Robert Frost. What kinds of feelings and thoughts is he giving to the bird? The oven bird's song is "teacher, teacher, teacher." Could the bird be teaching us a lesson?
- ∞ Link: "The Oven Bird"
- ∞ Video Link: Song of the Ovenbird